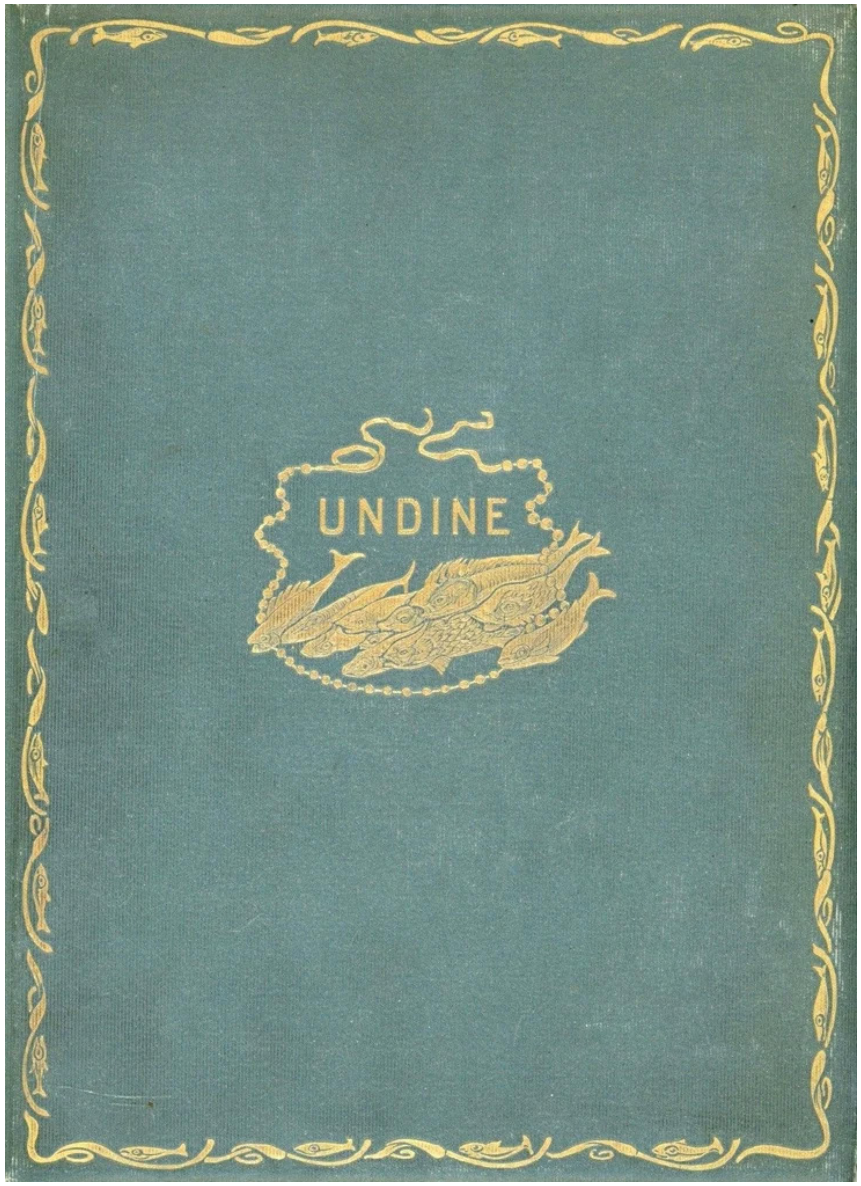
ZIN

AN EXPLORATION OF WATER THROUGH THE BODY AND THE SENSES, MY STYLE)

HELIA


UNDINE

Preface

I began by reflecting on my own values and the themes that repeatedly appear throughout my work.

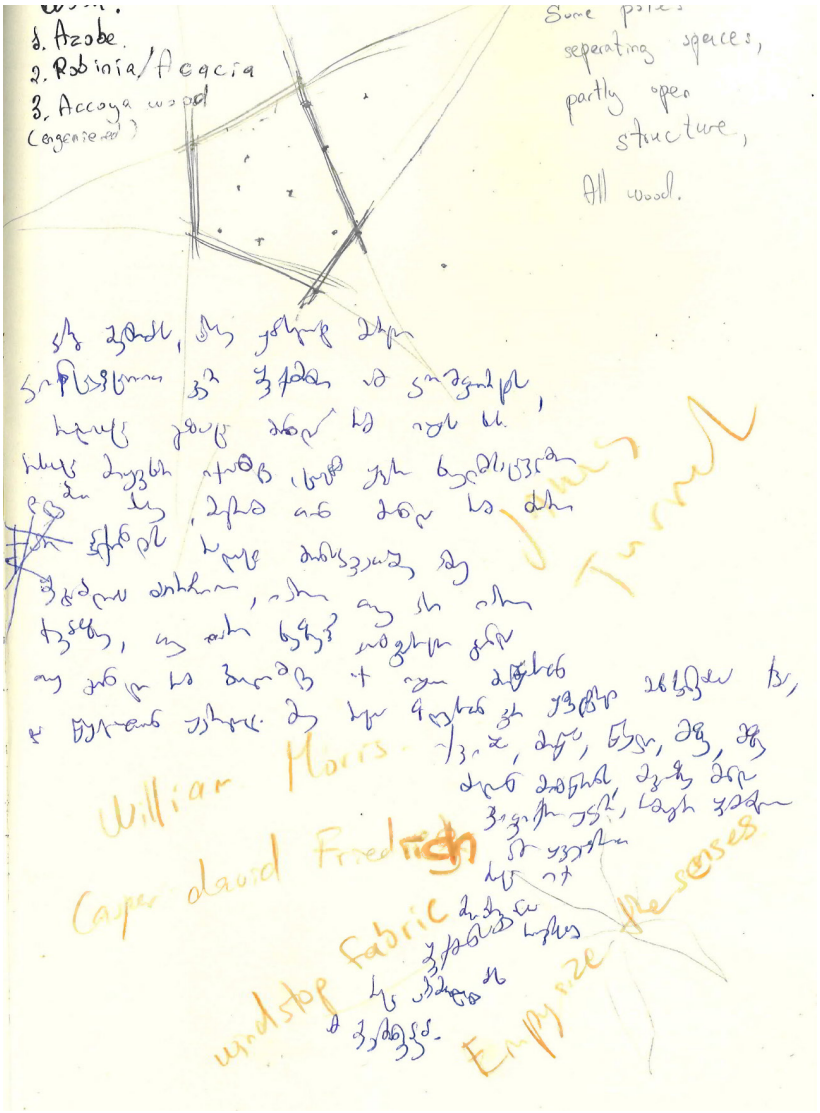
Many of my projects explore healing, connection, and the relationships between people and their environment. While searching for an approach to Terneuzen, my attention returned to water—not as a resource or landscape, but as a living presence.

In my imagination, water is inhabited by Undines: fluid beings that move through streams, oceans, mist, and air. They are deeply sensitive to the environment and have an affinity for the luminous, phosphorescent colors of the sea. I believe this, that they are always with us communicating everywhere.

With their guidance, I present ' ZIN '—a project that explores water through perception, presence, and sensory experience.

Undine: A Tale by Friedrich de la Motte Fouqué, 1897 London edition by Lawrence and Bullen, Ltd.

Architecture
as a medium
to connect



My hertwarming sketches of how the idea was formed:

speedily you are really pushing me into that is my

What would the sea want?

comfort, closure, affection, Love, choice, communication.

4) [illegible]

2) Among Kurdish women there is a long tradition of resistance and struggle for freedom and equality. Can you tell us more about this history?

3) Öcalan's ideas have had a profound impact on the Kurdish movement, including the women's movement. Can you explain how his ideas have influenced the movement? What role do women play in the movement? How do they see themselves in relation to Öcalan's ideas? Öcalan's ideas have had a profound impact on the Kurdish movement, including the women's movement. He has developed a unique ideology that combines elements of socialism, feminism, and democracy. His ideas have been particularly influential among women, who have been drawn to his emphasis on gender equality and his critique of patriarchy. Many women see themselves as both followers of Öcalan and as independent thinkers and activists in their own right. They have developed their own organizations and networks, and have played a leading role in the struggle for women's rights in Kurdistan and beyond. Some women have also criticized Öcalan's ideas for not going far enough in challenging traditional gender roles, or for being too focused on the struggle for national liberation at the expense of other issues. Overall, Öcalan's ideas have had a complex and multifaceted impact on the women's movement, inspiring many women to take up the struggle for freedom and equality, while also generating debate and discussion about the best way forward.



Introduction

This project began with a simple observation: water is everywhere, yet it often remains invisible. When we speak about water, we rarely speak about water itself. Instead, We tend to focus on what water contains or supports—plants, animals, resources, and ecosystems—while water itself remains in the background. I became interested in shifting attention towards water as a presence rather than a medium. This interest led me to the history of Zeeland, a region shaped through centuries of interaction with water. Floods, land loss, and continuous adaptation have created a unique relationship between people and their environment. Water is not only part of the landscape; it has actively shaped local culture, identity, and ways of living. While researching these histories, I noticed parallels with contemporary ways of understanding the world. Knowledge is often divided into categories and specializations. Each discipline examines a specific fragment while the larger whole becomes difficult to perceive.

Allmannajuvet Zinc Mine Museum / Peter Zumthor



I began comparing this to medicine, where different specialists focus on different organs while fewer practitioners attempt to understand the body as an interconnected system. The sea can be understood in a similar way. Marine biology studies organisms, chemistry studies substances, and engineering studies infrastructure, yet water itself often disappears behind these layers of interpretation. This realization became central to my project. Rather than investigating what exists within water, I wanted to investigate how water itself could be perceived. From this point, my attention shifted towards the human body and the ways we experience the world through the senses. To translate these reflections into a spatial experience, I explored the twelve senses and their relationship to architecture. From this research, movement and touch emerged as the most relevant senses. Both require active participation and create a direct relationship between the body and its surroundings.

The project developed through the intersection of these themes: water as a presence, Zeeland as a landscape shaped by water, and the body as a tool for understanding. Architecture became a medium through which these relationships could be experienced rather than explained.

The island of the Dead: "New York" version, 1880Arnold Bocklin

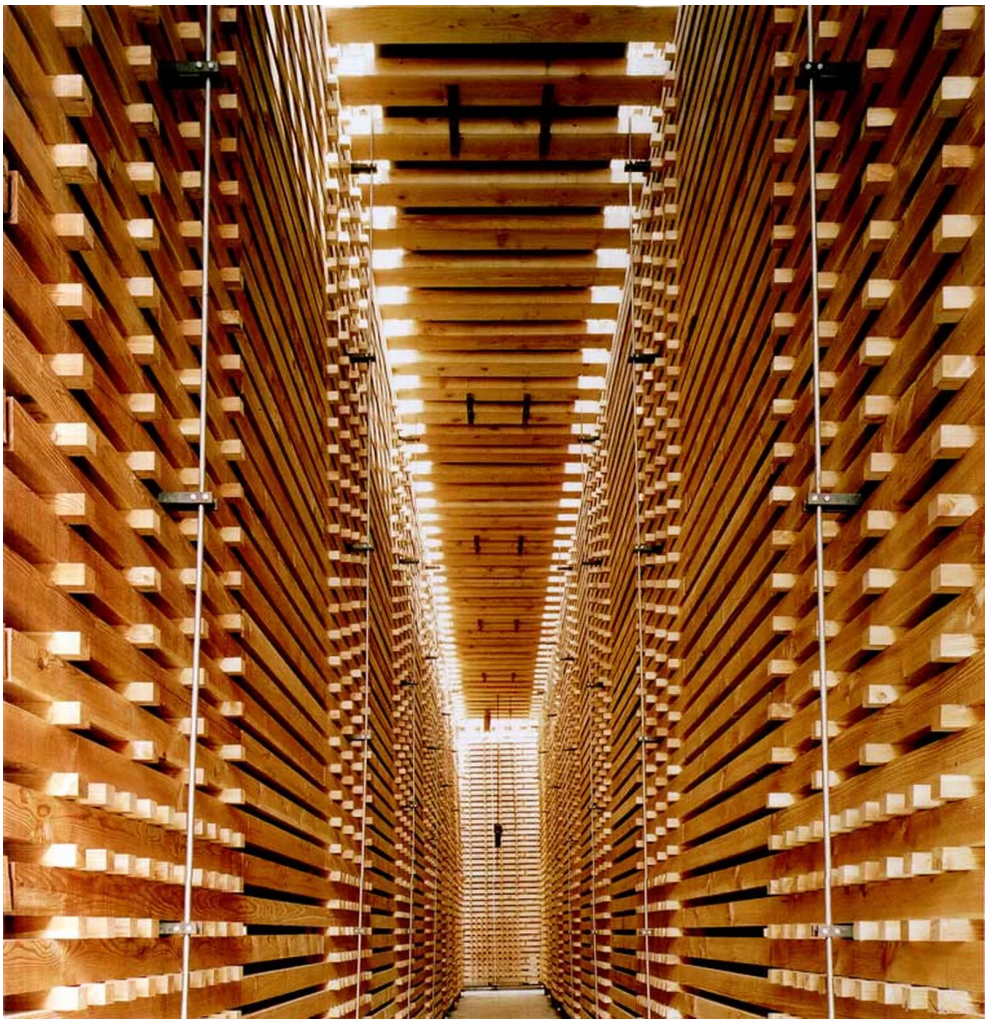


I started my work by reading. I read 'Atmospheres', 'Thinking Architecture', 'Complexity and Contradiction in Architecture', 'A Feeling of History', 'Swiss Sound Box', and many other books. Through this process I found myself returning again and again to Peter Zumthor.

At first, I did not like him. My boyfriend is an architect, and he made me watch interviews with him. We watched them together, but I was not inspired. I was surprised by how much people admired him. He seemed to be talking about things that were already very clear to me. I remember feeling annoyed because everything he said felt obvious, as if he was simply stating facts about how architecture should be.

My boyfriend then told me something that stayed with me. He said that what feels obvious to me is not obvious to everyone else, and that this is one of the reasons why Zumthor is such an important figure. That made me curious. I do not trust people easily through a screen. I dislike the idea of getting to know someone through the internet or through interviews. So instead of watching him, I decided to read him.

Natura morta Giorgio Morandi
1963 , museo Morandi, Bologna



Swiss Sound Pavilion
Hannover, Germany 2000

When I started reading his books, everything changed. Suddenly many things that felt complex became clear. At times it felt as if I was reading my own thoughts. There was a feeling of comfort, of being understood. Each paragraph seemed to confirm something I had always believed but had never been able to express. Everything intertwined. It felt magical.

I could not stop reading. I borrowed books from the library and later bought some of them because I enjoyed them too much to let go. Through his writing I began to understand the person behind the architecture. What I found was someone very simple. I admire that. There is a peacefulness and honesty in his way of thinking that I deeply appreciate. We are very different people, but we share values that are important to me.

With his guidance accompanying me, I began working on my architectural object. Because of the limited time available, the project is neither grand nor complete. It remains simple, almost like a sketch. Yet I do not see that as a weakness. I see it as the beginning of something that I hope to continue developing long after this project ends.

ATMOSPHERES

1) Body of Architecture

A real human body parallell.

A body that can touch me.

A membrain, A fabric, covvering, cloth, velvet, silk.

2) Material Compability.

Materials reach with one another and have their radience, so that the material composition gives rise to something unique. Material is endless.

"Andrea Palladio"

There's a critical proximity between materials, depending on the type of material and it's weight. You can combine different materials in a building, and there's a certain point where you'll find they're too far away from each other to react, and there's a point too where they're too close togeither, and that kills them.

3) The Sound of a Space

„Swiss Sound box"

I find it's a beautiful thing when you are making a building and you imagine the building in that stillness. I mean trying to make the building a quite place.

4) The Temperature of a Space

<to temper>

Temperature in this sense is physical, but presumably psychological too. It's in what I see, what I feel, what I touch, even with my feet.

It is well-known that materials more or less extract the warmth from our bodies. Steel, for instance, is cold and drags the temperature down.

5) Surrounding objects.

„Bienefeld houses in Cologne."

What's needed is a design that prevents things becoming too leisurely and nice. The idea of things that have nothing to do with me as an architect taking their place in a building, their rightful place – it's a thought that gives me an insight into the future of my buildings: a future that happens without me <a sense of

„Baudrillard's <System of Objects>" [4]

home>

especially its (the object's) bodily existence, its existence qua substance.

6) Between Composure and Seduction.

Architecture like music is a temporal art.

The feeling that I am not being directed but can stroll at will - just drifting along, you know?

Direction, Seduction, letting go, granting freedom.

where nothing is trying to coax you away, where you can simply be.

7) Tension between Interior and Exterior.

An Arena for individuals and the public, for the private and public spheres. Architecture knows this and uses it.

8) Levels of Intimacy.

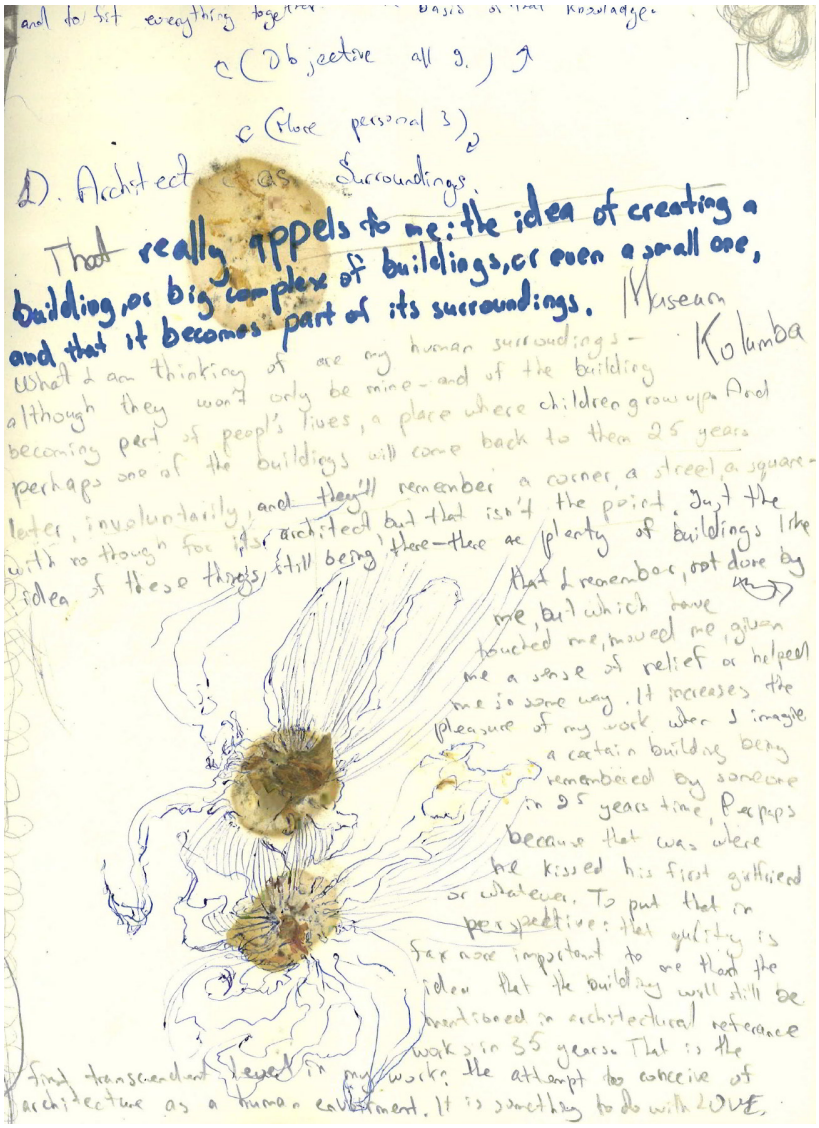
It all has to do with proximity and distance (i.e. scale)"

size, dimension, scale, the building's mass by contrast with my own,

9) The Light on Things

So, the first of my favourite ideas in this: to plan the building as a dense mass of shadow then, afterwards, to put in light as if you were hollowing out the darkness, as if the light were a new mass seeping in.

The second idea I like is this: To go about lighting materials and surfaces systematically and to look at the way they reflect the light. In other words, to choose the materials in the knowledge of the way they reflect



and to fit everything together ... Basis of that knowledge.

c (Objective all 9.) ↗

c (More personal 3) ↘

2). Architect ... as ... Surroundings.

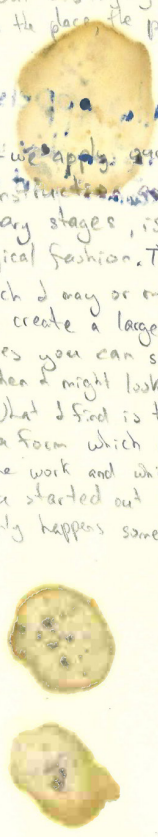
That really appels to me: the idea of creating a building, or big complex of buildings, or even a small one, and that it becomes part of its surroundings. Museum Kolumba

What I am thinking of are my human surroundings - although they won't only be mine - and of the building becoming part of peop's lives, a place where children grow up. And perhaps one of the buildings will come back to them 25 years later, involuntarily, and they'll remember a corner, a street, a square - with no thought for the architect but that isn't the point. Just the idea of these things, still being there - there are plenty of buildings I like that I remember, not done by me, but which have touched me, moved me, given me a sense of relief or helped me in some way. It increases the pleasure of my work when I imagine a certain building being remembered by someone in 25 years time, perhaps because that was where he kissed his first girlfriend or whatever. To put that in perspective: that quality is far more important to me than the idea that the building will still be mentioned in architectural reference work in 55 years. That is the final transcendent level in my work: the attempt to conceive of architecture as a human environment. It is something to do with LOVE.

2) Coherence

That is when everything refers to everything else and it is impossible to remove a single thing without destroying the whole. Place, use and form. The form reflects the place, the place is just so, and the use reflects this and that.

Form is not something we work on – we apply ourselves to all the other things. To sound, noises, materials, construction, anatomy, etc. The body of architecture, in the primary stages, is construction, anatomy: putting things together in a logical fashion. That is all that is demanded of me – here is the place, on which I may or may not have some influence, and this is the use. We generally create a large model, or a drawing. Usually it's a model. And sometimes you can see at that stage that it feels right – things cohering. And then I might look at it and say: sure, it coheres, only it isn't beautiful. What I find is that when things have come out well they tend to assume a form which often surprises me when I finally stand back from the work and which makes me think: you could never have imagined when you started out that this would be the outcome. And that is something that only happens sometimes, even after all these years of slow architecture.



My classification of how i view senses.

As the project developed, the ideas changed constantly. What remained throughout the process was the desire to create a collection of architectural pavilions based on the human senses.

For this project, I worked with the idea that humans have twelve senses.

Lower senses

1.Touch
2.Life
3.Movement
4.Balance

Middle senses

1.Smell
2.Taste
3.Sight
4.Warmth

Higher senses

1.Hearing (sound, voice, listening)
2.Word
3.Thought
4."I"



I became interested in how architecture could communicate through these senses rather than through form alone. Instead of creating a building to be looked at, I wanted to create spaces that could be experienced through the body.

The initial intention was to develop three pavilions, each focusing on a different combination of senses.

Pavilion I

Touch
Movement }

Pavilion II

Sight
Hearing }

Pavilion III

Warmth
Smell }

Each pavilion explores a different way of perceiving the environment. Together, they form a collection of sensory spaces, encouraging visitors to engage with the world through attention, experience, and presence.

Doshi Retreat
Balkrishna Doshi with Khushnu Panthaki Hoof and Sönke Hoof, 2025



Maquette of Pavilion I

As the project evolved, I began searching for a way to translate my thoughts about water into architecture. Rather than representing water directly, I became interested in expressing it through experience.

The still water vessel became the centre of the pavilion, while the senses became the elements that allow visitors to approach it. In this way, water is not explained but encountered.

The first pavilion explores:

1. Touch
2. Movement

These senses are expressed through the relationship between wood, textile, wind, and the body. Suspended linen moves continuously with the changing weather, creating shifting spatial conditions throughout the day. The movement of the fabric activates the space and encourages visitors to move with it, around it, and through it.

Touch emerges through closeness. The textile is not only seen but experienced physically. It softens the structure and creates moments of interaction between the visitor and the pavilion.

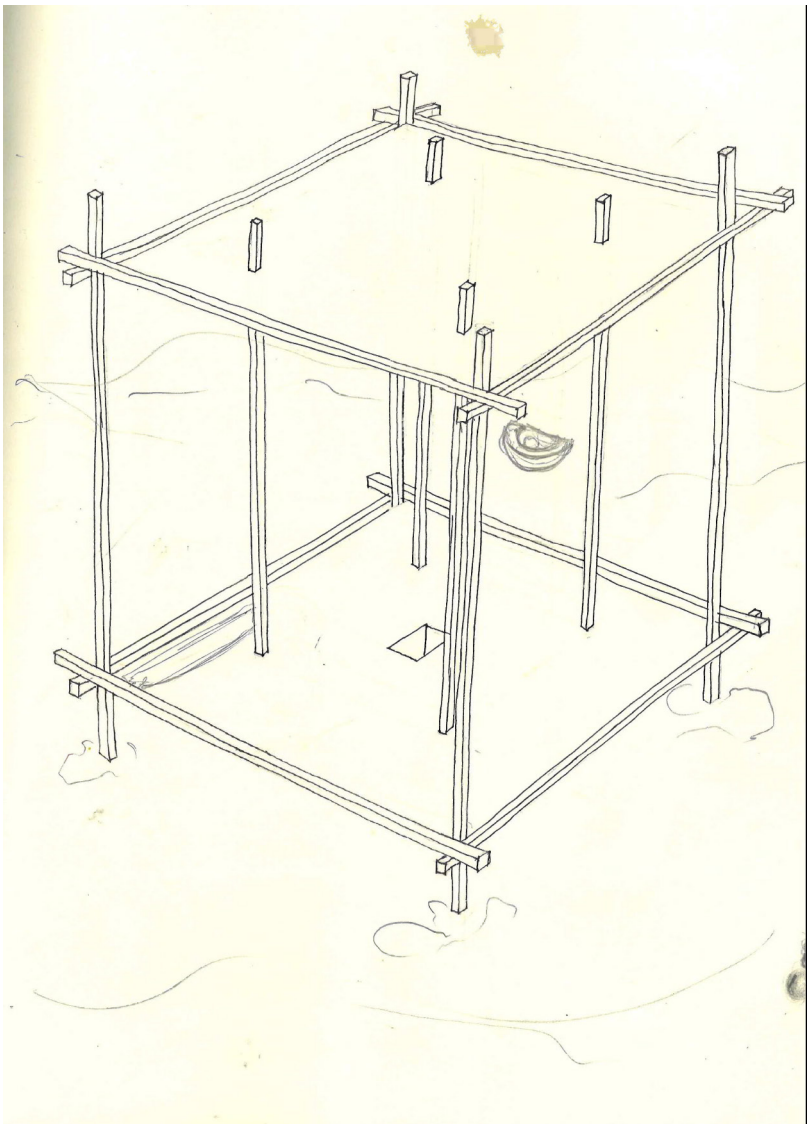
Rather than assigning a symbolic meaning to the senses, the project uses them as tools for perception. They become a way of slowing down, paying attention, and experiencing the space around the still water at the centre.

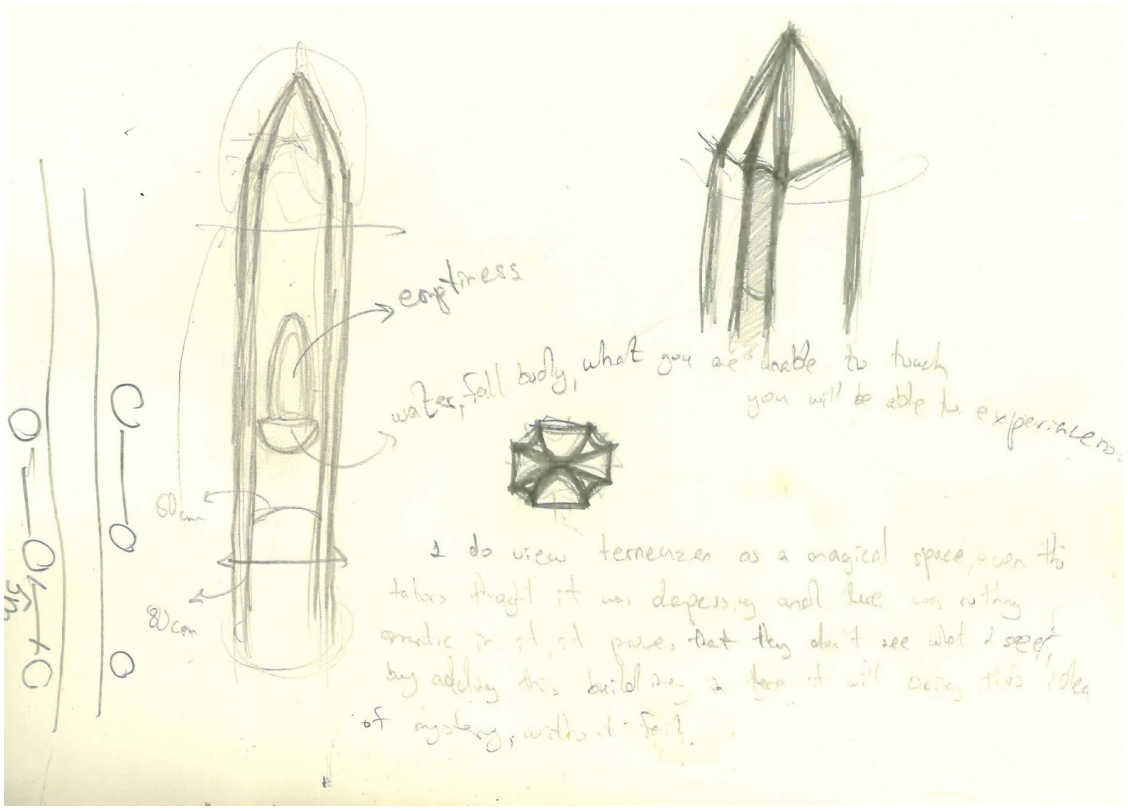


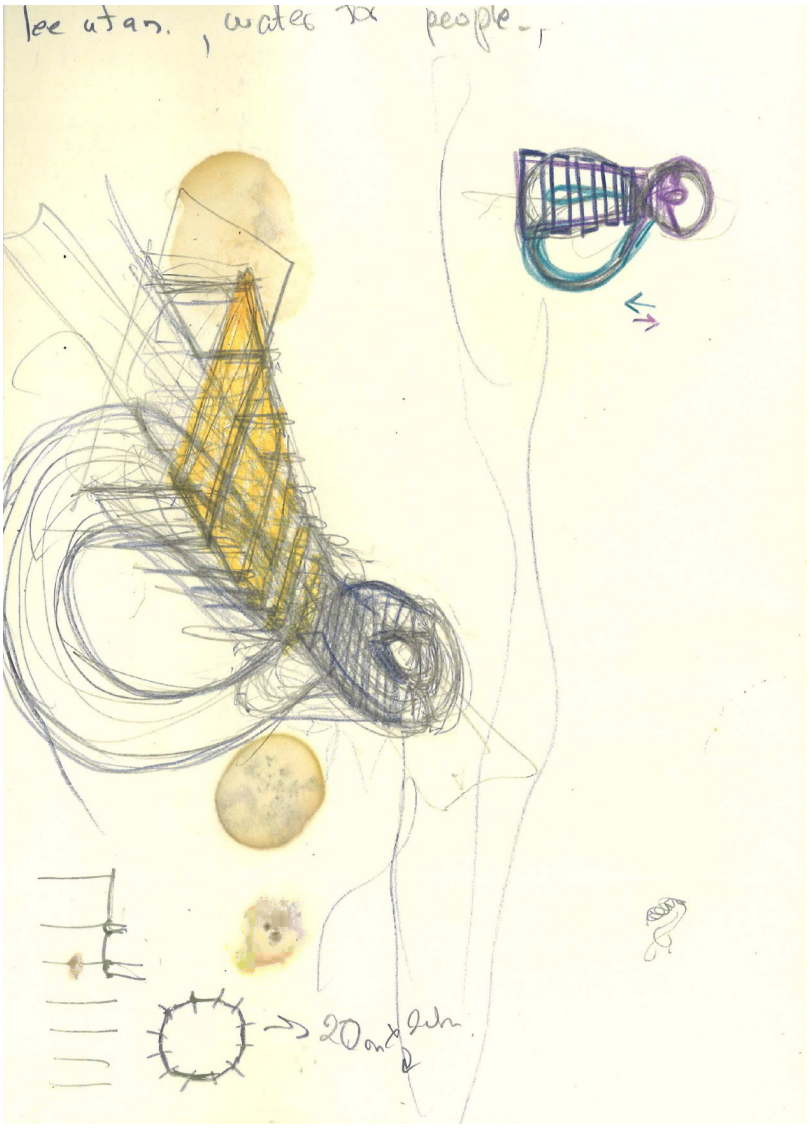

drink

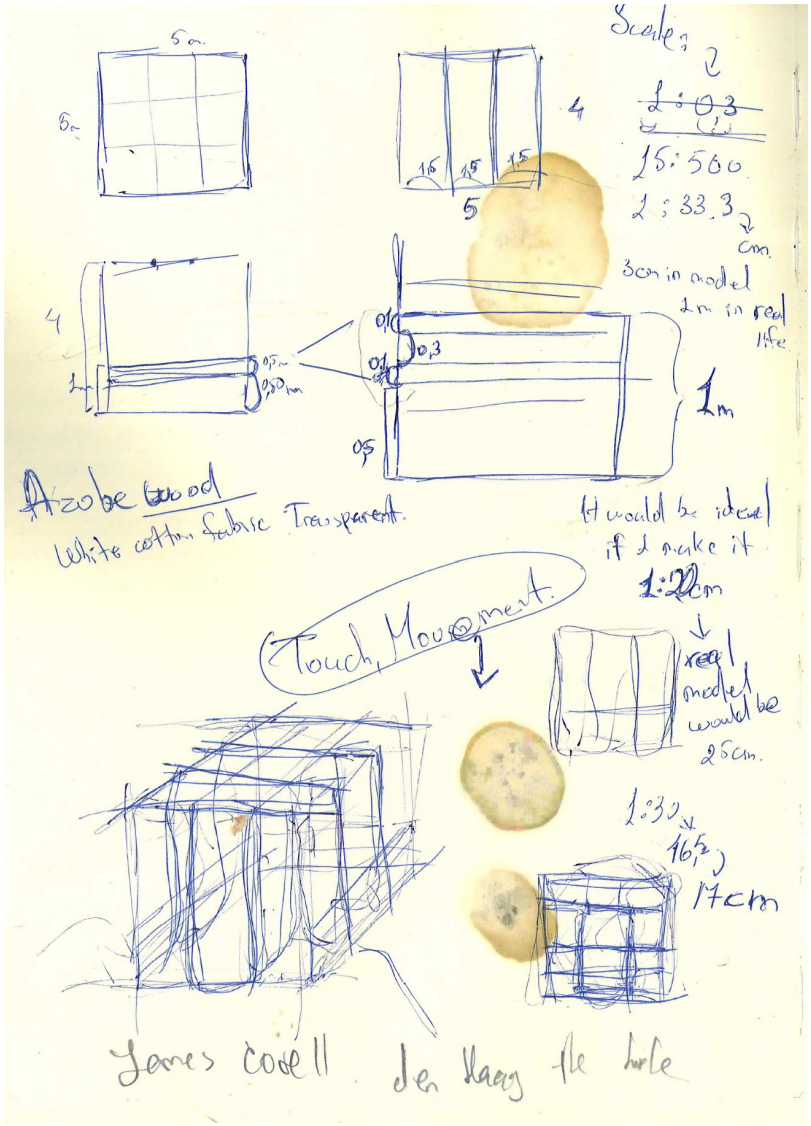


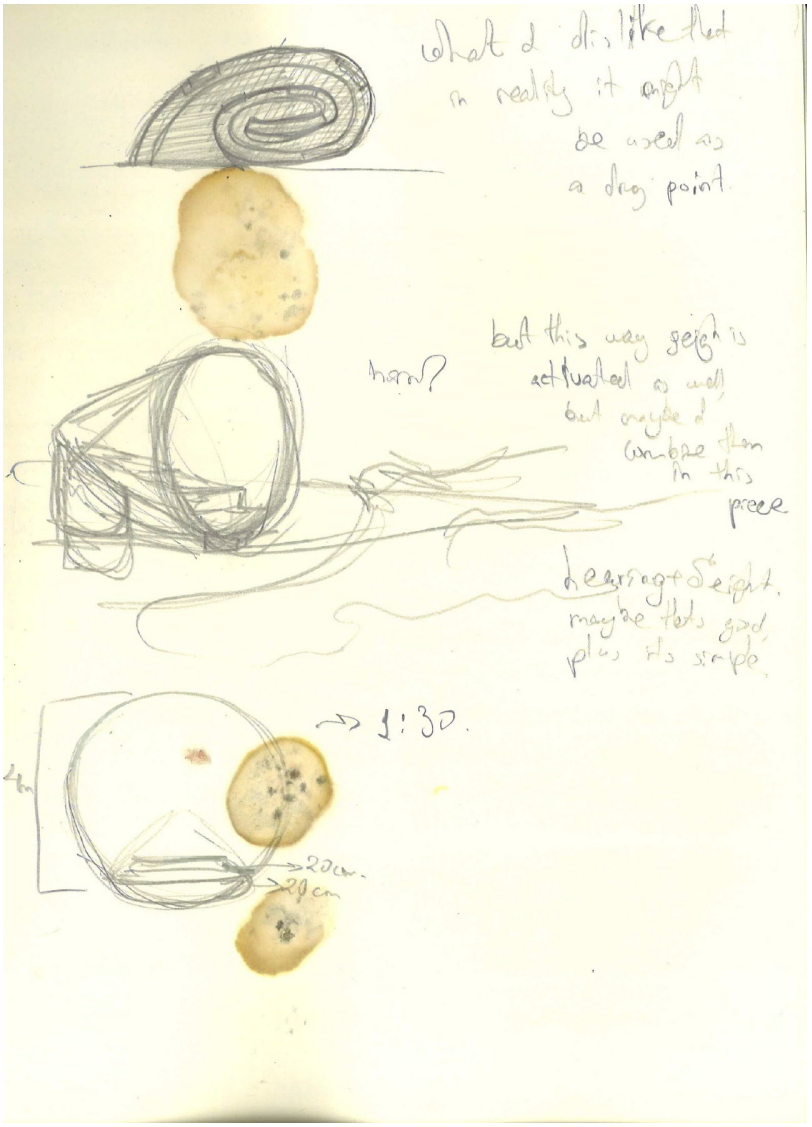


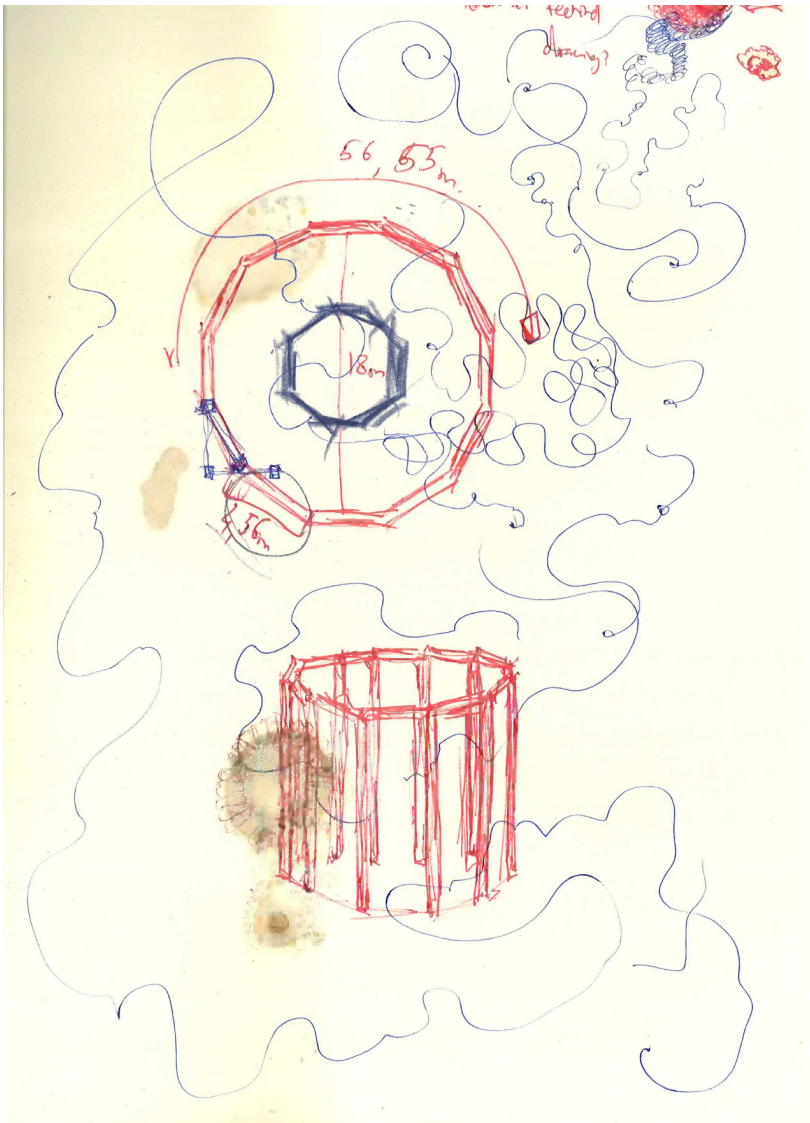



emptiness
water, full body, what you are unable to touch
you will be able to experience
80cm
80cm
I do view terrenuzen as a magical space, even tho
takes Angel it was depressing and there was nothing
ornatic in it, it pure, that they don't see what I see?
by adding this build ing + here it will carry this idea
of mystery, with it - fail.


lee utan. , water xx people -
20 cm


5cm
5cm
4
15
15
15
5
Scale:
1:0.3
15:500
1:33.3
cm
3cm in model
1m in real life
4
1m
0,5
0,3
Azobe wood
White cotton fabric Transparent.
It would be ideal if I make it
1:20cm
Touch Movement.
real
model would be
25cm.
1:30
16,5
17cm
James Cowell Den Haag the hole


what I dislike that in reality it might be used as a drag point
but this way weight is actuated as well but maybe I combine them in this piece
how?
leaning + weight. maybe that's good plus it's simple
→ 1:30.
4cm
22cm
20cm


56,53m.
18m
4,56m



THE STILL WATER PLACED IN THE MIDDLE OF THE PAVILION REPRESENTS A CONTRAST TO THE DYNAMIC SEA MOVING BELOW. WHILE THE SURROUNDING WATER IS CONSTANTLY CHANGING THROUGH WIND, CURRENTS, AND TIDES, THE WATER HELD WITHIN THE PAVILION REMAINS CALM.

I BECAME INTERESTED IN THIS RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN MOVEMENT AND STILLNESS, AND IN HOW ATTENTION CAN BE DIRECTED TOWARDS SOMETHING QUIET AND EASILY OVERLOOKED. DURING A TRIP TO BRUSSELS, I VISITED SEVERAL CHURCHES AND FOUND INSPIRATION IN THE WAY THESE SPACES ENCOURAGED ATTENTIVENESS. CERTAIN ELEMENTS BECAME MEANINGFUL NOT BECAUSE THEY WERE DRAMATIC, BUT BECAUSE THE ARCHITECTURE INVITED PEOPLE TO PAUSE AND NOTICE THEM.

THE STILL WATER FUNCTIONS IN A SIMILAR WAY. IT EXISTS AS A MOMENT OF CALM WITHIN A CONSTANTLY MOVING ENVIRONMENT, INVITING VISITORS TO BECOME AWARE OF ITS PRESENCE THROUGH CONTRAST.

Church in Brussels.

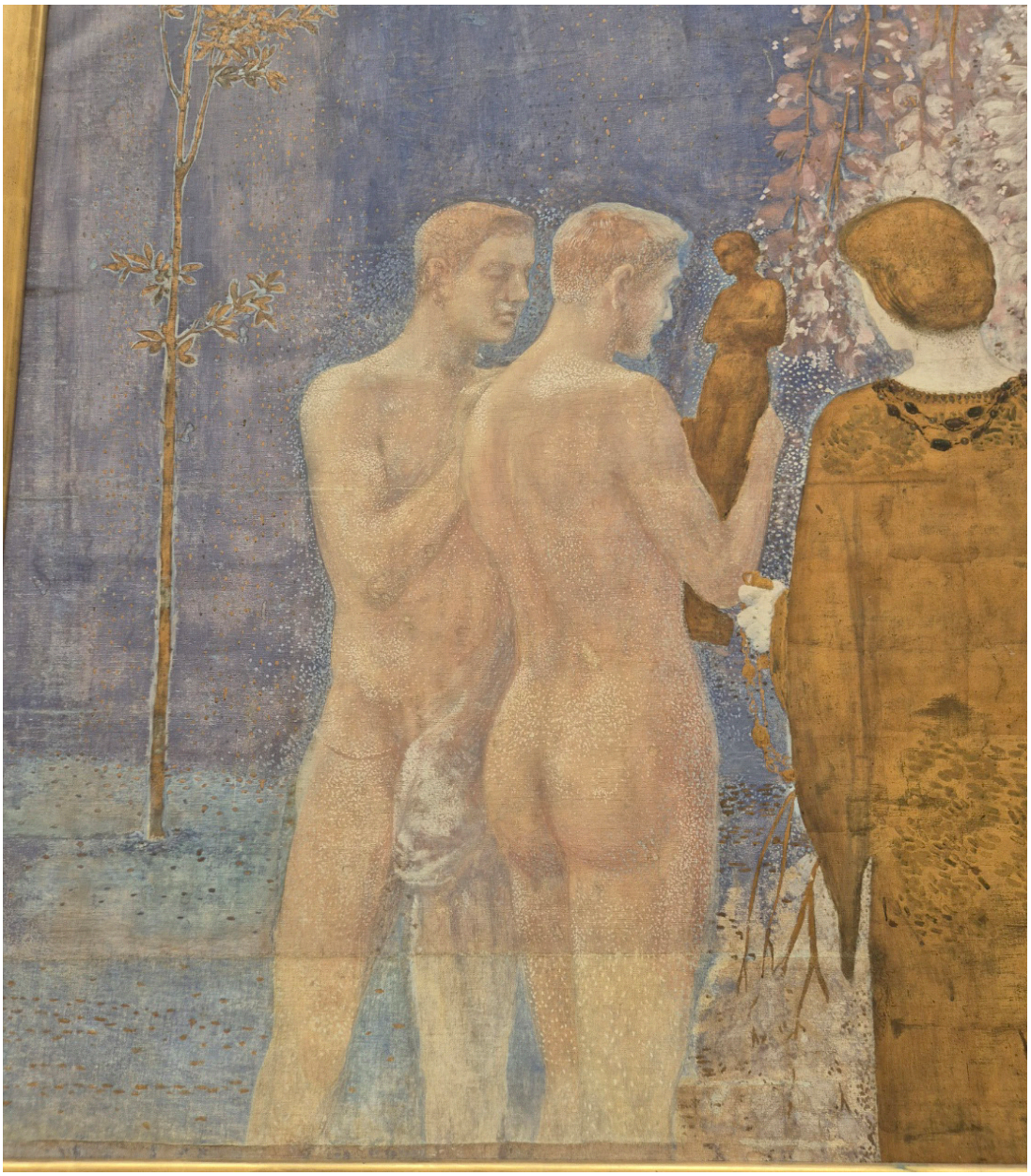


(Le domaine d'Arnheim) by surrealist artist René Magritte

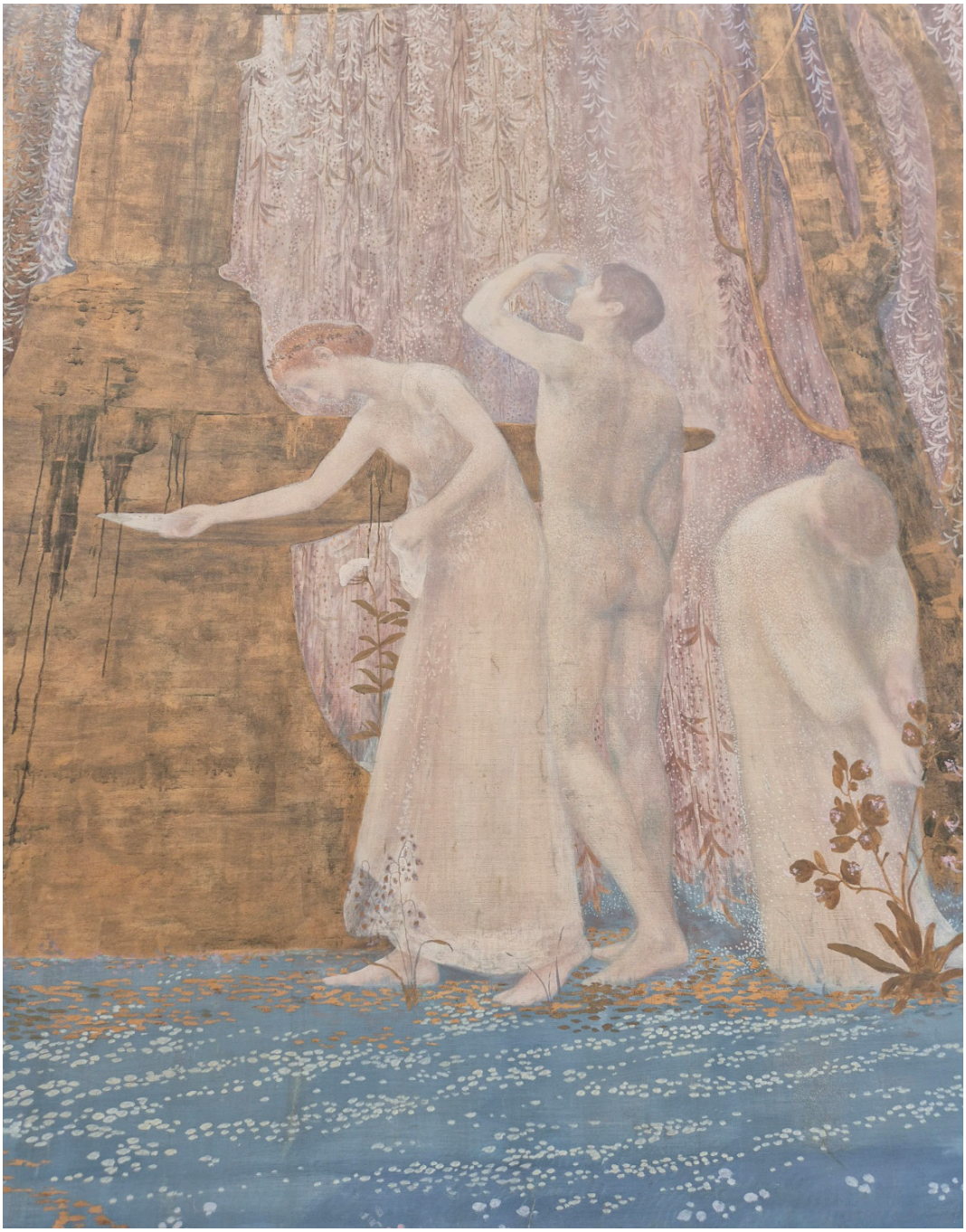




La Barque de l'Idéal), 1907 painting
by Belgian artist Constant Montald.







STANDING ABOVE THE WATER, THE PAVILION IS FORMED THROUGH THE INTERSECTION OF A TWELVE-SIDED AND AN EIGHT-SIDED GEOMETRY. CONSTRUCTED FROM AZOBÉ WOOD AND SUSPENDED LINEN, IT DRAWS ON MATERIALS AND CRAFTS LONG PRESENT WITHIN THE LANDSCAPE OF ZEELAND.

THE TEXTILE HANGS BETWEEN THE WOODEN STRUCTURE, RESPONDING TO THE WIND AND INTRODUCING CONTINUOUS MOVEMENT INTO THE SPACE. SHIFTING WITH CHANGING WEATHER CONDITIONS, IT INVITES BOTH TOUCH AND ATTENTION, MAKING THE SURROUNDING ENVIRONMENT TANGIBLE.

AT THE CENTRE OF THE PAVILION SITS A CIRCULAR BODY OF STILL WATER. IN CONTRAST TO THE WATER BELOW AND AROUND THE STRUCTURE, THIS SURFACE REMAINS CALM, CREATING A QUIET FOCAL POINT WITHIN AN OTHERWISE MOVING LANDSCAPE.

THROUGH THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN WOOD, TEXTILE, WIND, WATER, AND THE BODY, THE PAVILION BECOMES A SPACE FOR PAUSE, PERCEPTION, AND ENCOUNTER.